



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

STEPHENSON

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-5 neighborhood
Expected enrollment with no changes	271 in 2027-28; 261 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 360 students
Students living within 1 mile	29.2%
Building notes	School space is described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

Geographic isolation and low enrollment: Stephenson is isolated, with enrollment expected to drop to 261 students by 2031-32.

Neighboring Capacity: Closest schools (Markham and Capitol Hill) offer more room to comfortably accommodate the student body.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Stephenson School would close as a school building in Scenario A.

In Scenario A, 70% of its neighborhood school boundary would move to Markham K-5, and 30% would move to Capitol Hill K-5.

In Scenario B, Stephenson would remain open.

What could students gain?

Full student support networks: Joining Markham and Capitol Hill gives students access to larger student body sizes that support full-time PE, art, music, and support staff.

Updated buildings: Capitol Hill and Markham feature plenty of school space and planned building safety upgrades.

What else was considered?

Choosing the school students would move to: Stephenson was chosen for closure over Markham and Capitol Hill because of room for students and distance from where students live. As we look at who bears the burden of moving, we wanted to reduce the impact on students experiencing poverty and underserved communities and that is a contributing factor for moving Stephenson to Markham.

What about special education?

When combining school communities with distinct Special Education programming, we are planning and ensuring tailored support through the transition. Students who have specialized programming in a closing school will be assigned a new location for their IEP-identified programming. Students in the Communication Behavior Classroom (CB) at Stephenson will be receiving their services in a CB classroom at Capitol Hill Elementary School.

STEPHENSON

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

How many students are expected?

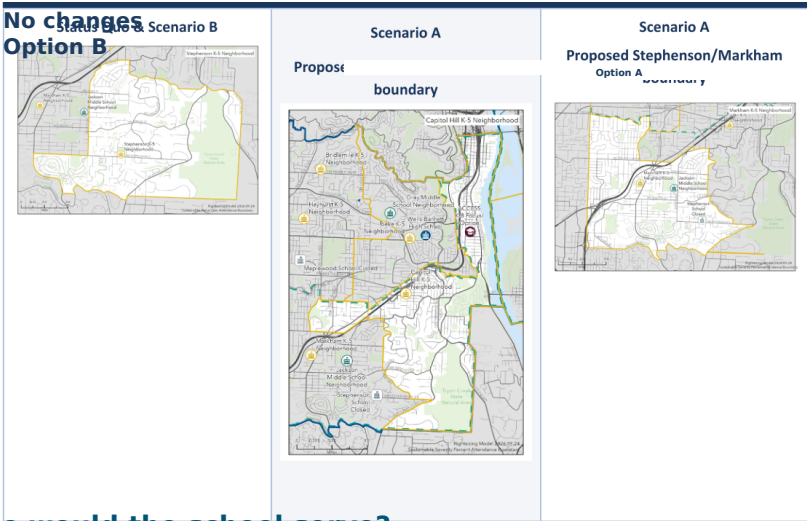
School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	271	264	251	260	261
Option B	271	264	251	260	261

Option A: The Stephenson facility closes. The Stephenson community joins with the Markham and Capitol Hill communities.

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Option A	Option B
Type of change	No changes	School would close	No changes proposed
Meets school size goal?	No	School would close	No
Meets space use goal?	No	School would close	No
Students living within 1 mile	29.2%	School would close	29.2%
Grades and programs	K-5 neighborhood	School would close	K-5 neighborhood

Where would the school boundary be?



Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	10.0%	17.8%	3.9%	16.7%	No
Option B*	10.2%	18.0%	3.9%	16.9%	No

Option A: the school would close.